

Re: Support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

On behalf of the Tri-Lakes Center for Independent Living (TLCIL), I am writing to express our strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's application to the Smart Growth Grant program to fund contractual services for accessibility upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach House.

TLCIL serves individuals with disabilities across the region, helping them achieve independence, participate fully in community life, and access recreational opportunities. Currently, Lake Colby Beach presents significant barriers for many of our clients due to the lack of ADA-compliant facilities. This limits their ability to enjoy swimming, picnicking, and other community activities alongside family and friends.

By funding professional contractual services to design and implement ADA-accessible bathrooms, lifeguard facilities, and safe pathways, this project will directly benefit our clients. These improvements will allow individuals with disabilities to safely and independently access one of the region's most popular recreational spaces. It will expand opportunities for community engagement, recreation, and wellness for the people TLCIL serves.

This project aligns closely with TLCIL's mission and demonstrates a commitment to equitable access for all community members. We strongly support the Village of Saranac Lake in pursuing this grant and urge your full consideration of their application.

Sincerely,

Tri-Lakes Center for Independent Living